



AN HOUR'S WORK Just an hour's extension for Gurugram's hospitality industry has led to a steep rise in revenue and created more jobs

CITIES THAT DON'T SLEEP



MAPS ARE FOR REPRESENTATION ONLY AND NOT TO SCALE

WHY CREATE A NIGHT-TIME ECONOMY?

- ▶ **The night-time economy has the potential to become a massive driver of direct and indirect economic growth for India's megacities**
- ▶ **It is a valued "third space" in society that is neither one's home nor office, where people can take a break from their hectic city life in the fast lane**
- ▶ **A thriving night-time economy in India's megacities has the potential to make them favoured tourist destinations, and not just transit points to other tourist locations in India**
- ▶ **The night-time economy is vulnerable due to a lack of regulation, and requires the care and protection of the local government in order to thrive**

ernments are a sideshow to the potential growth that a full-fledged night-time policy can bring to the country. For instance, an industry veteran who wishes to remain anonymous says that if the hospitality industry is allowed to operate through the night, tax revenues can go up substantially, and job creation, too, will get a boost of at least 15-20 per cent.

Globally, too, it's not only cafes, bars and nightclubs that make up the night-time economy. In cities with an active nightlife, apart from going to pubs and restaurants, a wide array of activities exist to complement the hospitality sector. The impact of these are felt in increased revenues and employment generation. For context, according to a report released by the London mayor's office, around 1.6 million people—constituting a third of everyone working in the city—worked at night in 2017. Of these, 191,000 worked in health, 178,000 in professional services, while the hospitality sector employed 168,000. These were closely followed by transport, automotive, information technology and education sectors. Meanwhile, the UK's total night-time economic output was pegged at £112 billion, around 5.1 per cent of the country's GDP before the pandemic started, according to a study conducted by the UK's Night Time Industries Association.

Similarly, in New York City, in 2016 (the year for which standardised data sets are available), the night-time economy supported nearly 299,000 jobs with \$13.1 billion in employee compensation, and \$35.1 billion in economic output. The pubs and restaurants sector's economic output was measured at \$2 billion from night-time sales, with tax revenue for the city coming in at \$697 million. Plus, the pubs and restaurants sector generated around 13,400 jobs and \$492 million in wages at night for the year, according to a report commissioned by the New York Mayor's Office of Media and Entertainment. Australia is no different. With a vibrant night-time economy in place, the nation witnessed a total turnover of \$128 billion in sales in 2019-20, although this was a decline of \$12 billion from the previous year,